decided to boycott the polls. Despite TULF's decision, the voter turnout in Jaffna was as high as 46 per cent.

Indian government spies closely monitored global dynamics that might have a bearing on Indian security. A note prepared by the MEA's analysis unit said:

The security environment around India has undergone a considerable change in the last one year. It is a matter of great concern to us that the change effected has been negative in so far as it has enhanced tensions, aggravated insecurity and heightened the possibility of global conflagration. Several regions of the world of particular interest to India are already embroiled in conflict: Afghanistan, Iraq, and Lebanon etc. The rivalry between superpowers has become more intense. The mushrooming of the area of tension around the world with large-scale induction of US arms is a fall-out of the confrontationist policies advocated by the Ronald Reagan administration and aimed at stemming what it perceives as the progressively enlarging Soviet sphere of influence and its determination to negotiate from a position of strength. The main cause for concern for India is the spectre of big power conflicts near our thresholds, which could embroil the country in a hot war by proxy or envelope it in the freezing embrace of cold war. The confrontationist US policies and the corresponding riposte of the Soviet Union have dealt a severe blow to detente between the superpowers. Attitudes towards detente and disarmament have been hypocritical and discriminatory and attempts to achieve the end halfhearted and deceptive. The arms aid policy of the Regan administration marks a shift from the previous US policy in that it does not take into consideration the human rights aspect. The sole criterion for a country to be entitled to US arms assistance is its